





Pour ne jamais oublier

Ariane Bilodeau, Dînette 020, 2021

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IGNITION is an annual exhibition that features new work by students currently enrolled in the Studio Arts or Humanities graduate programs at Concordia University. It provides an unpandcoming generation of artists with a unique opportunity to present ambitious, interdisciplinary works in the professional context of a gallery with a national and international profile. Graduate students work directly with Gallery staff to produce an exhibition that places an emphasis on critical, innovative, and experimental work, engaging in the exploration and consideration of diverse media and practices.

IGNITION 14

May 2 – June 2, 2018

Matthew Brooks, Brent Cleveland, Mara Eagle, Muhammad Nour Elkhairy, Malcolm McCormick, Emilie Morin, Claire Ellen Paquet, Etta Sandry, Adam Simms, Undine Sommer

Projects selected by Tammer El-Sheikh and Michèle Thériault

Wednesday, May 2
Meet the artists: 4 pm
Opening: 5:30 – 7:30 pm

Ways of Thinking
Exhibition Floorplan

In choosing works for this annual exhibition Michèle Thériault and I considered the artists' words, or descriptions of what they would like to show, and images of past works or works-in-progress that gave us a sense of their respective styles. The proposals were like missives, to which we replied initially with more words: bold, haunting, romantic, incisive, considered, darkly funny or just plain dark.

There was no guiding theme for the exhibition, but connections between the works abound. After imagining the selected projects in the space, I kept circling back to two senses of the word "articulation" as a stand-in for a theme—the linguistic sense of a clear and coherent expression or speaker, and the more spatial sense of a joint, corner or link. Through the articulation of their practices, the selected artists reflect a feature of Concordia's MFA pedagogy—that each takes responsibility in thought and in words for their works. The artists in IGNITION 14 have done this brilliantly. The second sense is more difficult to explain. By accident, or serendipity, or Michèle Thériault's intuition, or a combination of these, the works were grouped in the gallery to suggest some form of an articulation—a joint, a corner, a link—between nature and culture, surfaces and depths, speaking, writing and fighting, and between thoughts of home and the feeling of being away.

In the first room **Claire Ellen Paquet** and **Etta Sandry's** pieces are frozen in mid-conversation. Paquet's looming banners showing excerpts from a book by Charles Darwin are confronted by Sandry's leaning textile piece that captures the cycle of sunrise and sunset as a gestalt. In the next room, **Matthew Brooks's** crisp nighttime views of vacant road-side architecture face-off with portraits of **Brent Cleveland's** gooey and libidinally-charged cast of characters. These pairs of works describe then trouble a taken-for-granted line between nature and culture. Around the corner, **Malcolm McCormick's** divided room-installation offers an anatomical view of painting as a play between decorative surfaces, constructed and projected depths, and ideal angles of vision. With this we are plunged into virtual and actual rooms for writers' views. As **Mara Eagle** retraces facsimiles of Jane Austen's correspondence live in the gallery, **Muhammad Nour Elkhairy's** looped videos explore the exile's task of writing-as-wish-fulfillment and as rehearsal. The concept of articulation in these works is freighted with the gender-politics of a channeled Victorian author, and the anti-colonial politics of Palestinians in the diaspora. Along the back of the gallery in three separate rooms, the concept comes up in works that explore the gaps and joints between home and away. Again, we are with exiles: on a suspenseful bike-ride home at dusk in **Undine Sommer's** video; in the undulation of a dangling piece of driftwood, live-streaming a Newfoundland tide in **Adam Simms's** kinetic sculpture; and in the gallery's meeting room for an experiment with mediated intimacy in **Emilie Morin's** Skype performance from her Montreal apartment.

Commentary by Tammer El-Sheikh

This exhibition is part of the Montreal Digital Spring 2018.

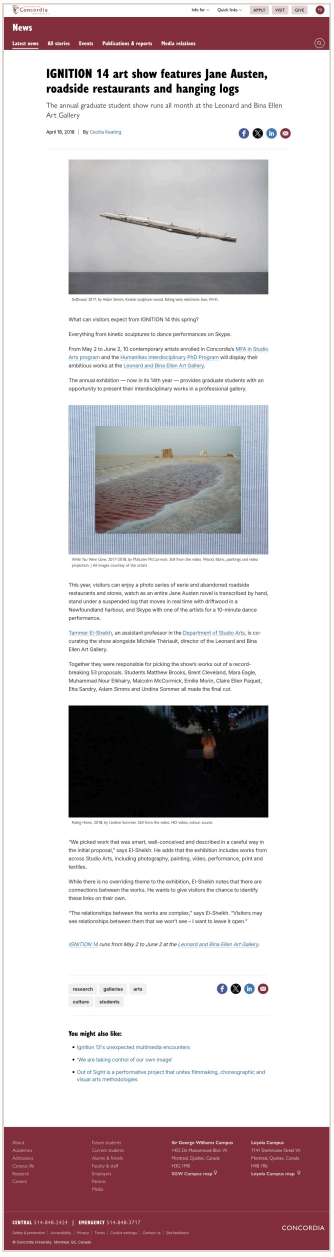
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Concordia University is located on unceded Indigenous lands and the Kanien'kehá:ka (Ga-niyen-ge-haa-ga) Nation are recognized as the custodians of the lands and waters on which we gather. We respect the continued connections with the past, present and future in our ongoing relationships with Indigenous and other peoples within the Tiohtiá:ke/ Montreal community.

IGNITION 14
Tammer El-Sheikh, Ellen Art Gallery, 2018
ellengallery.concordia.ca/exposition/ignition-14



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IGNITION 14 art show features Jane Austen, roadside restaurants and hanging logs

The annual graduate student show runs all month at the Leonard and Bina Ellen Art Gallery

April 10, 2018 | By Cecilia Keating

Driftwood, 2017, by Adam Simms. Kinetic sculpture: wood, fishing wire, electronic box. Photo:

What can visitors expect from IGNITION 14 this spring?

Everything from kinetic sculptures to dance performances on Skype.

From May 2 to June 2, 10 contemporary artists enrolled in Concordia's MFA in Studio Arts program and the Humanities Interdisciplinary PhD Program will display their ambitious works at the Leonard and Bina Ellen Art Gallery.

The annual exhibition — now in its 14th year — provides graduate students with an opportunity to present their interdisciplinary works in a professional gallery.

Still from: Where You Were Gone, 2017-2018, by Malcolm McCormick. Still from the video. Wood, fabric, paintings and video projection. | All images courtesy of the artists

This year, visitors can enjoy a photo series of eerie and abandoned roadside restaurants and stores, watch as an entire Jane Austen novel is transcribed by hand, stand under a suspended log that moves in real time with driftwood in a Newfoundland harbour, and Skype with one of the artists for a 10-minute dance performance.

Tammer El-Sheikh, an assistant professor in the Department of Studio Arts, is co-curating the show alongside Michèle Thériault, director of the Leonard and Bina Ellen Art Gallery.

Together they were responsible for picking the show's works out of a record-breaking 53 proposals. Students Matthew Brooks, Brent Cleveland, Mara Eagle, Muhammad Nour Elkhairy, Malcolm McCormick, Emilie Morin, Claire Ellen Paquet, Etta Sandry, Adam Simms and Undine Sommer all made the final cut.

Riding Home, 2018, by Undine Sommer. Still from the video. HD video, colour, sound.

"We picked work that was smart, well-conceived and described in a careful way in the initial proposal," says El-Sheikh. He adds that the exhibition includes works from across Studio Arts, including photography, painting, video, performance, print and textiles.

While there is no overriding theme to the exhibition, El-Sheikh notes that there are connections between the works. He wants to give visitors the chance to identify these links on their own.

"The relationships between the works are complex," says El-Sheikh. "Visitors may see relationships between them that we won't see – I want to leave it open."

IGNITION 14 runs from May 2 to June 2 at the Leonard and Bina Ellen Art Gallery.

research | galleries | arts | culture | students

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- Ignition 13's unexpected multimedia encounters
- 'We are taking control of our own image'
- Out of Sight is a performative project that unites filmmaking, choreographic and visual arts methodologies

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IGNITION 14
Cecilia Keating, Concordia News, 18 Apr 2018
concordia.ca/news/stories/2018/04/18/ignition-14-art-show-features-jane-austen-roadside-restaurants-and-hanging-logs.html







À louer / For Rent

James D. Campbell, Ciel variable 92, Fall 2012

cielvariable.ca/en/issues/ciel-variable-92-true-north/a-louer-for-rent-uma-various-venues-montreal-james-d-campbell